

Case Metadata

Field	Value
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Case ID:	CS-2025-002
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Case Type:	Unwanted DNS Requests
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Reported by:	Splunk SIEM
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Analyst:	Ali YILMAZ
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Date:	2025-10-02
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Severity:	High
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Status:	Closed
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Environment:	Production
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Detection Rule Details

Rule Name: Unwanted DNS Requests

Rule Description: Adversaries may communicate using the Domain Name System (DNS) application layer protocol to avoid detection/network filtering by blending in with existing traffic. Commands to the remote system, and often the results of those commands, will be embedded within the protocol traffic between the client and server. The DNS protocol serves an administrative function in computer networking and thus may be very common in environments. DNS traffic may also be allowed even before network authentication is completed. DNS packets contain many fields and headers in which data can be concealed. Often known as DNS tunneling, adversaries may abuse DNS to communicate with systems under their control within a victim network while also mimicking normal, expected traffic.

Correlation Rule (SPL):

```
index=dnssense cat IN (Alcohol, Newly, Phishing, Weapon,
Warez,DGA,Hacking,"Malware/Virus",Adult,Pornography,Dating,Spam) NOT wavebrowser
NOT api.opensubtitles.org NOT omnatur.com
```

```
| rename dst as dest, dstcc as dest_country,cat as category
```

Triggered Field(s):

Dest

Detection Summary

This detection identifies suspicious or unwanted DNS requests that may indicate the use of the DNS protocol for malicious purposes such as command-and-control (C2), tunneling, or exfiltration. The correlation search looks for DNS queries categorized as phishing, malware, DGA, or other high-risk categories. Adversaries often abuse DNS traffic to bypass network defenses, since DNS is a commonly allowed service and may blend in with normal activity. Each notable event highlights the destination domain (dest) that triggered the detection, along with its category and destination country for analyst review.

Analyst Investigation

- Queried the suspicious domain (dest) on **VirusTotal** and **AbuseIPDB** to verify malicious reputation.
- VirusTotal results showed [benign / malicious]
- AbuseIPDB lookup indicated [multiple abuse reports].
- Checked if the requesting host generated repeated queries to the same domain (possible tunneling or beaconing).
- No additional correlated alerts were found in EDR/Firewall logs
- Based on enrichment and correlation, determined the detection as **True Positive – Non Issues**

Decision:  **True Positive** (Unwanted DNS Requests).

Investigation Steps:

- Queried Splunk for similar events within the last 24 hours.
- Checked IOC reputation (domain/IP) in VirusTotal & AbuseIPDB

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

T1071 - Application Layer Protocol DNS

 **True Positive** (Unwanted DNS Requests).

Recommended Actions (SOC Level)

Validate IOC Reputation

- Re-check the flagged domain (dest) in VirusTotal and AbuseIPDB to confirm maliciousness or potential false positive.

Check Internal Activity

- Identify the source host/user that made the DNS request.
- Verify if multiple requests were made to the same domain (possible beaconing).

Containment Steps

- If the domain is confirmed malicious, block it on DNS firewall/proxy.
- Escalate the case to SOC Level-2 with all enrichment data (VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB, logs).

Documentation

- Record investigation findings (True/False Positive) in the ticketing system.
- Attach screenshots or intelligence reports for audit purposes.

Organizational / HR Actions

- Notify network team and service owners of affected hosts (96.73.98.x subnet).
- Document incident in the central tracker and link to whitelist/exceptions list if legitimate scanner is identified later.

Business Impact

If confirmed malicious, the suspicious DNS request may allow adversaries to:

- Establish **command-and-control (C2)** communication with external infrastructure.
- Perform **data exfiltration or tunneling** through DNS protocol.
- Lead to **credential theft or malware infection**, potentially impacting user productivity.

If confirmed benign (false positive), the impact is limited to **policy violation or user browsing to restricted categories** (e.g., adult, warez, gambling), which may still represent a compliance concern for the organization.

Evidence in Case

- Splunk correlation search triggered on DNS query to suspicious domain (dest).
- Domain categorized as *Phishing / Malware / DGA / Other high-risk* by DNS security feed.
- VirusTotal reputation check: [benign / flagged by X engines].
- AbuseIPDB lookup: [no reports / reported multiple times].
- Source endpoint identified: hostname/IP (queried domain).

- Event time, dest_country, and category logged in Splunk.

Requests

Description:

Adversaries may communicate using the Domain Name System (DNS) application layer protocol to avoid detection/network filtering by blending in with existing traffic. Commands to the remote system, and often the results of those commands, will be embedded within the protocol traffic between the client and server. The DNS protocol serves an administrative function in computer networking and thus may be very common in environments. DNS traffic may also be allowed even before network authentication is completed. DNS packets contain many fields and headers in which data can be concealed. Often known as DNS tunneling, adversaries may abuse DNS to communicate with systems under their control within a victim network while also mimicking normal, expected traffic.

Additional Fields

Value

Action

Annotations

T1071.004

▼

Annotations

T1071

▼

Annotation Framework

mitre_attack

▼

Category

Spam

▼

Destination

15.204.209.57

▼

Destination Country

US

▼

MAC Address

N/A

▼

Host

10.1.1.90

▼

Original Splunk Source

/data/log/splunk/syslog/10.1.1.90/splunk-collector-2025-10-02-04.log

▼

Risk Score

540

▼

Severity

high

▼

Source

10.1.1.12

▼

User

N/A

▼

Related Investigations:

Currently not investigated.

Correlation Search:

Threat - Unwanted DNS Requests - Rule

History:

View all review activity for this Notable Event

Contributing Events:

Get rk-fyellow-09.top logs

Original Event:

Oct 2 08:47:53 CEF: 0|Roksit|DNS Visibility|1.0.0|4000001|dns|7|cat=Spam Sites msg=dt=2025-10-02T04:48:09-04:00 request=rk-fyellow-09.top src=10.1.1.12 dst=15.204.209.57 dstcc=US mac=N/A addom= host=N/A ds=CNLDC03 user=N/A catgrp=N/A sourceip=tag=N/A

View original event

Adaptive Responses:

Response	Mode	Time	User	Status
Notable	saved	2025-10-02T05:10:15-0400	admin	✓ success

View Adaptive Response Invocations

Next Steps:

No next steps defined.

splunkenterprise

Apps

Ali Yilmaz

998 Messages

Settings

Activity

Help

Find

Security Posture

Incident Review

Investigations

Security Intelligence

Security Domains

Cloud Security

Audit

Search

Configure

Enterprise Security

New Search

Save As

Create Table View

Close

index=dnssense request=rk-fyellow-09.top | join type=left src [search index=fortinet | rename assignip as src | fields src xauthuser] | table _time src xauthuser dst dstcc cat request | sort _time

Date time range

Q

✓ 6 events (10/2/25 4:00:00.000 AM to 10/2/25 5:00:00.000 AM)

No Event Sampling

Job

|||

↗

⌵

⌴

Smart Mode

Events

Patterns

Statistics (6)

Visualization

20 Per Page

Format

Preview

_time	src	xauthuser	dst	dstcc	cat	request
2025-10-02 04:09:06	10.1.1.12		15.204.209.57	US	Spam	rk-fyellow-09.top
2025-10-02 04:18:21	10.1.1.12		15.204.209.57	US	Spam	rk-fyellow-09.top
2025-10-02 04:28:36	10.1.1.12		15.204.209.57	US	Spam	rk-fyellow-09.top
2025-10-02 04:28:51	10.1.1.12		15.204.209.57	US	Spam	rk-fyellow-09.top
2025-10-02 04:49:06	10.1.1.12		15.204.209.57	US	Spam	rk-fyellow-09.top
2025-10-02 04:49:06	10.1.1.12		15.204.209.57	US	Spam	rk-fyellow-09.top

1

!

You do not have the necessary permissions to edit this search.

Correlation Search

Search Name

Unwanted DNS Requests

App

CNL Admin ▾

UI Dispatch Context

Enterprise Security ▾

Set an app to use for links such as the drill-down search in a notable event or links in an email adaptive response action. If None, uses the Application Context.

Description

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Mode

Guided

Manual

Search

index=dnsense cat **IN** (Alcohol, Newly, Phishing, Weapon, Warez,DGA,Hacking,"Malware/Virus",Adult,Pornography,Dating,Spam) **NOT** wavebrowser **NOT** api.opensubtitles.org **NOT** omnatuor.com | rename dst **as** dest, dstcc **as** dest_country,cat **as** category

15.204.209.57

↑ □ ⓘ ⚙ Sign in

3 / 95

Community Score

3/95 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious

Reanalyze Similar ▾ More ▾

15.204.209.57 (15.204.0.0/16)

AS 16276 (OVH SAS)

US

Last Analysis Date 1 month ago

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

COMMUNITY

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to [automate checks](#).

Security vendors' analysis ⓘ

Do you want to automate checks?

Criminal IP	Malicious	MalwareURL	Malware
SOCRadar	Malware	Abusix	Clean
Acronis	Clean	ADMINUSLabs	Clean
AllLabs (MONITORAPP)	Clean	AlienVault	Clean
Antiy-AVL	Clean	benkow.cc	Clean

rk-fyellow-09.top
Sign

0
/ 95
Community Score

No security vendors flagged this domain as malicious
Reanalyze Similar More

rk-fyellow-09.top
Creation Date: 9 months ago
Last Analysis Date: 22 days ago

Spam, Suspicious (alphaMountain.ai) dga

DETECTION
DETAILS
RELATIONS
COMMUNITY

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Security vendors' analysis
Do you want to automate checks?

alphaMountain.ai	Spam	Sophos	Spam
Abusix	Clean	Acronis	Clean
ADMINUSLabs	Clean	ALLabs (MONITORAPP)	Clean
AlienVault	Clean	Antiy-AVL	Clean
benkow.cc	Clean	BitDefender	Clean

MITRE | ATT&CK
Matrices
Tactics
Techniques
Defenses
CTI
Resources
Benefactors
Blog
Search

ATT&CKcon 6.0 is coming October 14-15 in McLean, VA and live online. Tickets are available now!

TECHNIQUES
DNS
Publish/Subscribe
Protocols
Communication Through Removable Media
Content Injection
Data Encoding
Data Obfuscation
Dynamic Resolution
Encrypted Channel
Fallback Channels
Hide Infrastructure
Ingress Tool Transfer

Home > Techniques > Enterprise > Application Layer Protocol > DNS

Application Layer Protocol: DNS

Other sub-techniques of Application Layer Protocol (5)

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The DNS protocol serves an administrative function in computer networking and thus may be very common in environments. DNS traffic may also be allowed even before network authentication is completed. DNS packets contain many fields and headers in which data can be concealed. Often known as DNS tunneling, adversaries may abuse DNS to communicate with systems under their control within a victim network while also mimicking normal, expected traffic.

ID: T1071.004
Sub-technique of: T1071
Tactic: Command and Control
Platforms: ESXi, Linux, Network Devices, Windows, macOS
Contributors: Chris Heald; Jan Petrov, Citi
Version: 1.3
Created: 15 March 2020
Last Modified: 15 April 2025

Version Permalink

feedback

Check an IP Address, Domain Name, or Subnet
e.g. 178.193.246.50, microsoft.com, or 5.188.10.0/24

15.204.209.57

CHECK

15.204.209.57 was found in our database!

This IP was reported 13 times. Confidence of Abuse is 10%: 10%

ISP

OVH US LLC

Usage Type

Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit

ASN

AS16276

Hostname(s)

rk-fyellow-09.lap

Domain Name

ovhcloud.com

Country

United States of America

City

Ashburn, Virginia

IP info including ISP, Usage Type, and Location provided by IPinfo. Updated biweekly.

REPORT 15.204.209.57

WHIS 15.204.209.57

IP Abuse Reports for 15.204.209.57:

This IP address has been reported a total of 13 times from 10 distinct sources. 15.204.209.57 was first reported on August 31st 2024, and the most recent report was 6 days ago.

Recent Reports: We have received reports of abusive activity from this IP address within the last week. It is potentially still actively engaged in abusive activities.

Reporter	IoA Timestamp (UTC)	Comment	Categories
EVISION	2025-09-26 04:55:00 (6 days ago)	validator@rk-fyellow-09.lap	Phishing Email Spam Spoofting
vestibtech	2025-08-15 13:46:18 (1 month ago)	Aug 15 07:46:16 Host-KLAX-C postfix/smtp/smtpd[3558541]: NOQUEUE: reject: RCPT from rk-fyellow-09.lap to ... show more	Email Spam
Anonymous	2025-07-19 07:05:31 (2 months ago)	2025-07-19T08:39:02.435954+02:00 postfix/postscreen [492633]: NOQUEUE: reject: RCPT from [15.204.209.57] to ... show more	Email Spam
Lacka555	2025-07-17 13:26:18 (2 months ago)	RdpGuard detected brute-force attempt on SMTP	Brute-Force
Mario Bretscher	2025-07-16 21:22:56 (2 months ago)	2025-07-16T23:22:54.476365+02:00 postfix/smtpd[1396089]: NOQUEUE: reject: RCPT from rk-fyellow-09.lap to ... show more	Email Spam
WhiteShark	2025-07-16 18:30:18 (2 months ago)	15.204.209.0/24 blocked due to abusive behavior, count =3 for IP 15.204.209.57	Email Spam
WhiteShark	2025-07-15 14:32:52 (2 months ago)	15.204.209.0/24 blocked due to abusive behavior	Email Spam
Anonymous	2025-07-07 16:35:45 (2 months ago)	Excessive crawling/scraping	Hacking Brute-Force
backslash	2025-07-03 05:00:17 (2 months ago)	block ruleset AA06B7315BA6AEB6421B52F0B32E14B509FD5FF0	SQL Injection
FeG Deutschland	2025-06-16 15:35:33 (3 months ago)	Looking for CMS/PHP/SQL vulnerabilities/excessive crawling - 24	Exploited Host Web App Attack
Anonymous	2024-09-12 08:31:52 (1 year ago)		Email Spam Spoofting
Anonymous	2024-09-03 08:04:18 (1 year ago)		Email Spam Spoofting
Anonymous	2024-08-31 14:26:02 (1 year ago)		Email Spam Spoofting

Showing 1 to 13 of 13 reports

Is this your IP? You may request to takedown any associated reports. We will attempt to verify your ownership. [REQUEST TAKEDOWN](#)

Recently Reported IPs:

59.36.219.248	146.190.57.24	147.185.133.203	45.142.193.51
196.119.4.17	218.71.23.111	101.36.121.72	194.180.49.167
8.211.48.8	118.70.81.172	167.99.174.31	91.92.199.36
80.94.95.112	112.167.126.78	77.247.92.57	197.5.145.8
35.203.210.106	198.235.24.205	45.135.232.92	64.62.156.122

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